



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Sager Classical Academy
School Website: <https://sageracademy.com/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

SCL MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Sager Classical Academy (SCA) in Siloam Springs, AR presents a clear Classical Christian orientation with strong evidence across most categories of the classical rubric. Public materials emphasize a Christ-centered liberal-arts framework, formation of virtue, engagement with Great Books and the Great Conversation, and a faculty culture oriented toward character formation and mentorship. The school demonstrates robust alignment with Categories 1 (Religious & Metaphysical Foundations), 2 (Purpose & Goal), 3 (Curriculum), 5 (Faculty). Element 4 (Pedagogy) and Element 6 (Parents & Community) show substantial classical intent but with less explicit, universal articulation in available materials, yielding a few gaps that keep those categories from full CLASSICAL without some caveats. The aggregate assessment is CLASSICAL, with opportunities to move Element 4 and Element 6 toward full classical alignment.

Key supporting evidence:

- Public materials identify SCA as a preK–12 classical Christian school rooted in Christ, with emphasis on the Great Conversation, Great Books, and the seven liberal arts.
- The school's portrait of a graduate foregrounds Truth, Beauty, and the Great Tradition, including explicit aims to "investigate truth," "cultivate beauty," and participate in the Great Conversation/read the Great Books.
- Curricular framing centers on the liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and the Great Books/Great Conversation; the school presents a formational vision of education beyond mere information.
- Faculty philosophy emphasizes teachers as the heart of the academy, mentoring, and living the curriculum; professional development and Christian formation are highlighted.
- In terms of community, there are signals of parent engagement and school-community links (Volunteering, parent-facing communications), though there is more room to explicitly articulate parents-as-co-teachers.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL
- Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL
- Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL
- Element 6: Parents & Community — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

ABSTRACT follows this section and provides a concise synthesis.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- SCA identifies itself as a classical Christian school, situating education within a Christ-centered framework. This is explicitly stated in the public materials describing the school's identity.
- The school text explicitly states Christian rootedness, e.g., "Classical Christian education is rooted in Christ."
- The site emphasizes the Great Commission through the Great Conversation, signaling theological aims entwined with intellectual formation.
- The Portrait of a Graduate emphasizes reverence for truth and beauty, and references to truth, goodness, and beauty as transcendent aims.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present (from the lexicon's indicators): truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, theology, reverence/wonder, liturgy/more liturgical concepts are implied through worship/Christ-centered language, and "incarnational" worldview concepts are echoed in the Christ-centered framing. Specifically: truth; goodness; beauty; virtue; theology; wonder; reverence. The school text explicitly includes "rooted in Christ," "Investigate Truth," and "Cultivate Beauty."
- Negative keywords present: minimal to none in the accessible public materials (no clear relativism signals found). The canonical negative indicators in the knowledge base lexicon include relativism and values-clarification, which are not evident in the SCA public pages.

Why this rating

- The public materials present a robust religious-metaphysical framework anchored in Christian theism, virtue, and a transcendent view of truth/goodness/beauty. The explicit Christ-centered language and the integration of Great Books with a theological frame align strongly with Classical Education's Religious & Metaphysical Foundations. The absence of explicit negative signals and the presence of transcendentally anchored aims justify CLASSICAL.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school's purpose centers on virtue and wisdom rather than employment preparation, anchored in formation and human excellence, as described in classical pedagogy explanations and in the school's own articulation of its mission. The classical education framing emphasizes cultivation of virtue and wisdom.
- The Portrait of a Graduate points to "Investigate Truth," "Cultivate Beauty," and the role of reason within a Great Tradition, signaling formation of character and intellect rather than mere information.
- Great Books/Great Conversation framing indicates formation through engagement with enduring ideas rather than vocational rote.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: virtue; wisdom; formation; truth; beauty (and the phrase "Great Conversation" and "Great Books") appear in school materials. The explicit aim of forming character and intellect through the liberal arts is stated.
- Negative keywords present: none detected in accessible public materials; no "values clarification" or relativism signals are evident.

Why this rating

- The school clearly articulates virtue- and wisdom-centered aims and emphasizes formation as the core purpose of education, consistent with Classical tradition. The presence of the Portrait of a Graduate and Great Books/Great Conversation framing supports CLASSICAL.
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Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The curriculum is framed around the liberal arts and the Great Books/Great Ideas, with explicit references to the seven liberal arts. The public materials emphasize reading Great Books and engaging in the Great Conversation.
- The school description highlights a classical curriculum centered on the true, good, and beautiful, with liberal-arts orientation and formation through the arts of learning.
- The Portrait of a Graduate and related pages present the “Great Tradition” and engagement with Great Books as curricular anchors.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: liberal arts; grammar, logic, rhetoric (as part of the seven liberating arts); Great Books; Great Conversation; formation through the arts. The site references “the seven liberating arts” and “Great Books / Great Conversation.”
- Negative keywords present: none evident. The lexicon’s relativism/values-clarification indicators are not visible in the school’s public curricular language.

Why this rating

- The site emphasizes liberal-arts pedagogy and engagement with Great Books and the Great Conversation, a hallmark of classical curricular practice. The explicit reference to the seven liberal arts strengthens CLASSICAL alignment.
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Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Portrait of a Graduate foregrounds intellectual method, including “Reason Well” and engagement with logical principles, which aligns with classical pedagogy’s emphasis on reason and rhetoric.
- The school emphasizes a relationship-centered teaching approach, with teachers described as modeling virtue, forming relationships with students, and acting as the living curriculum. This supports classical pedagogy but does not always specify the full spectrum of classical methods (e.g., explicit Socratic discussions in all grades).
- While Great Books/Great Conversation framing is present, explicit references to Socratic discussions, seminars, debates, and formal rhetoric instruction are not consistently documented across accessible pages (though there is emphasis on rhetoric in certain materials and the presence of a strong teacher-student mentorship culture).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: reason well; logic; Great Conversation; Great Books; engagement with tradition; rhetoric (explicit mentions are limited but implied via “Great Conversation” and “Reason Well”). The explicit phrase “Socratic discussion” is not clearly visible in the accessible content; “seminars” or “debates” are not consistently documented.
- Negative keywords present: None clearly identified; however, the absence of explicit, wide-ranging Socratic/seminar-based language across all grades reduces the explicitness of classical pedagogy in the available public materials.

Why this rating

- The pedagogy leans strongly toward classical formation (truth-seeking, virtue, reason, Great Books) but does not consistently document the full spectrum of classic pedagogical methods (e.g., explicit, high-frequency Socratic seminars in all grades, regular rhetoric-performance opportunities) across the public materials. This yields SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL.

What would move the needle

- Add explicit, classroom-level documentation of Socratic dialogue, seminars, and debates across middle and high school, with sample lesson descriptions or rubrics.
- Provide a public, grade-band breakdown of how logic, rhetoric, and the liberal-arts sequence are implemented in K–8 and 9–12, with performance benchmarks tied to the Great Books program.
- Highlight explicit opportunities for public speaking and rhetorical performance (speech days, debates, etc.) and align these with the school's stated rhetoric of training in rhetoric.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The faculty is described as model teachers and mentors who model virtue, skill, and knowledge; teachers are the heart of the academy, and the living curriculum is anchored in teacher-student relationships.
- The school emphasizes professional development and investment in teachers, signaling a culture of excellence and formation.
- The employment materials set out theological criteria and Christian standards for staff, emphasizing mission alignment and forming a Christian classroom culture.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: model teachers and mentors; living curriculum; teachers as core; professional development; Christ-centered instruction; virtue and knowledge; close teacher-student relationships; mission alignment. The evidence lines include “The teachers are the heart of our academy,” “invests in our teachers with professional development,” and “cultivate Christian culture.”
- Negative keywords present: none explicit in the public materials.

Why this rating

- The materials portray a high-caliber faculty culture with a “living curriculum” emphasis, strong mentorship, and professional development, consistent with CLASSICAL.

Element 6: School Parents & Community — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- There are signals of parent engagement and community interaction (e.g., a “Volunteering” page and parent-facing communications). The Volunteering page indicates structured parent involvement opportunities, suggesting partnership with families.
- The site references parent-facing resources and a parent network (e.g., LinkTree for SCA Parents Page), indicating ongoing parent access to information and involvement venues.
- Public materials emphasize communication with families and a mission that involves students, families, and church/community networks in formation. The employment pages likewise reference relationships with families in the school environment.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: partnership with parents; families; parent communications; visiting the school; resources for families; opportunities to engage (volunteering). Examples include “SCA Parents LinkTree” and volunteering communications.
- Negative keywords present: none explicit; however, explicit language about parents-as-co-teachers or structured parent-education programs is not consistently documented, which lowers the strength of the community-partnership signal in public pages. The lexicon’s explicit category-negative signals (like “values clarification” or relativism) are not present in the public pages.

Why this rating

- The school shows tangible parent involvement mechanisms and communications, but the language does not consistently and explicitly frame parents as co-teachers or provide a broad, continuous program for parent education and systematic engagement. This yields SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL.

What would move the needle

- Publish explicit language and programs that frame parents as co-teachers (e.g., joint learning events, parent education series on classical education, regular parent-teacher collaborative projects).
 - Expand formal parent education offerings (book studies, lectures on classical education philosophy) and provide visible, scheduled opportunities for parents to learn about the Great Conversation, Great Books, and the liberal-arts sequence.
 - Increase parental access to classrooms and consistent, structured opportunities for voluntary involvement that align with classical pedagogy (with background on how parent participation contributes to formation and virtue).
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What Would Move the Needle

- For Element 4 (Pedagogy): Add explicit documentation and examples of Socratic discussion, seminars, debates, and public rhetoric work across grade bands; publish a k-12 Pedagogy Guide showing how the Great Books program translates into daily classroom practice and assessment rubrics.
 - For Element 6 (Parents & Community): Institute formal parent-education programs (e.g., book studies, lectures on classical education, and faculty-led workshops) and clearly articulate the role of parents as partners and co-educators; publish an annual family engagement plan with metrics.
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Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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